

topics

- 1) DLQueue
- 2) retry mechanism
- 3) fan out

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KAFKA SHORT NOTES

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1) TOPICS AND THEIR USE

- Topic = Logical category where messages are stored.
- Producer publishes to a topic.
- Consumers subscribe to a topic.
- Topic is divided into partitions.

Example:

order.created
order.payment.completed

Use:

- Decouple services
- Enable async communication
- Event-driven architecture

2) PUBLISHER SMALL SETUP (SPRING BOOT)

application.properties

spring.kafka.bootstrap-servers=localhost:9092

Producer Service

```
@Autowired
private KafkaTemplate<String, Object> kafkaTemplate;

public void publishOrder(Order order) {
    kafkaTemplate.send("order.created", order);
}
```

Flow:

Order Object

↓
JsonSerializer
↓
Kafka Broker
↓
Stored in Topic Partition

3) CONSUMER SMALL SETUP (SPRING BOOT)

application.properties

spring.kafka.bootstrap-servers=localhost:9092

Consumer Listener

```
@KafkaListener(
    topics = "order.created",
    groupId = "payment-group"
)
public void consumeOrder(Order order) {
    System.out.println(order);
}
```

Flow:

Consumer joins group

↓

Kafka assigns partition

↓

Polls messages

↓

Processes message

↓

Commits offset

4) PARTITIONING AND OFFSET

Partition:

- Topic is divided into partitions.
- Enables parallel processing.
- Ordering guaranteed only inside one partition.

Example:

Topic: order.created

Partition 0:

Offset 0 → Order1

Offset 1 → Order4

Partition 1:

Offset 0 → Order2

Offset 1 → Order5

Offset:

- Sequential number inside partition.
- Tracks consumer progress.
- Stored per (Consumer Group + Partition).

Rule:

Next read = Last committed offset + 1

5) SMALL END-TO-END FLOW

User places order



Order Service



Publish → order.created topic



Kafka stores message in Partition



Payment Service consumes



Payment successful



Publish → order.payment.completed



Delivery Service consumes

6) ZOOKEEPER AND KAFKA SERVER (LOCAL)

Old Setup:

ZooKeeper + Kafka Broker

ZooKeeper:

- Managed metadata
- Leader election
- Broker coordination

Kafka Broker:

- Stores messages
- Handles partitions
- Serves producers & consumers

Modern Setup (Recommended):

Kafka in KRaft mode (No ZooKeeper)

Local:

- Run Kafka via Docker
- Expose port 9092
- Connect via localhost:9092

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KEY FORMULA
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Partition → Parallelism

Consumer Group → Load balancing

Offset → Progress tracking

Kafka → Event backbone

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1) RETRY MECHANISM IN KAFKA
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Retry is used when message processing fails temporarily
(DB issue, API failure, network error).

Instead of losing the message, the consumer retries processing.

Flow:

Producer
↓
Kafka Topic
↓
Consumer reads message
↓
Processing fails
↓
Retry message
↓
If retry limit reached → DLQ

Common Retry Approaches

1) Immediate Retry

- Retry inside consumer code.
- Not recommended for heavy workloads.

2) Retry Topics (Production Pattern)

```
order.created
  ↓ fail
order.created.retry.5s
  ↓ fail
order.created.retry.1m
  ↓ fail
order.created.dlq
```

3) Spring Kafka Retry

```
@RetryableTopic(
    attempts = 3,
    backoff = @Backoff(delay = 5000)
)
```

Used when failures are temporary.

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2) OFFSET COMMITTING

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Offset = position of a message inside a partition.

Kafka uses offset to track which messages a consumer has processed.

Structure:

Consumer Group + Partition + Offset

Example:

Partition 0

Offset 0 → Order1

Offset 1 → Order2

Offset 2 → Order3

If offset 1 committed → next read starts from offset 2.

Types of Offset Commit

1) Auto Commit

`enable.auto.commit=true`

Kafka automatically commits offsets periodically.

Risk:

Message may be lost if processing fails after commit.

2) Manual Commit (Recommended)

Process message

↓

Commit offset

Spring Example:

`ack.acknowledge()`

Ensures message processed before committing offset.

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3) DLQ (DEAD LETTER QUEUE)

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DLQ stores messages that cannot be processed even after multiple retries.

Purpose:

- Prevent message loss
- Allow debugging
- Prevent blocking consumer

Flow:

`order.created`

↓ fail

Retry Topic

↓ fail

Retry Topic

↓ fail

`order.created.dlq`

DLQ message usually contains:

- original event
- error reason
- retry count
- timestamp

Engineers later inspect DLQ and decide to:

- reprocess
- fix data
- discard message

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4) EVENT ID IN KAFKA

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Event ID is a unique identifier for each message.

Kafka itself does NOT generate event IDs.
The producer service generates them.

Usually generated using:

```
UUID.randomUUID()
```

Example event:

```
{  
  "eventId": "a1b2c3",  
  "orderId": "ORD123",  
  "status": "CREATED"  
}
```

Purpose:

- prevent duplicate processing
- track events
- enable idempotency

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5) DUPLICATE EVENT ID HANDLING

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Kafka can sometimes deliver duplicate messages due to:

- consumer retry

- network failure
- rebalance
- producer retry

To avoid processing duplicates, consumers implement IDEMPOTENCY.

Approach:

Before processing event:

Check if eventId already processed.

Flow:

Consumer receives event



Check eventId in storage



If exists → ignore

If not exists → process event



Store eventId

Where eventId is stored:

1) Database table

processed_events

event_id

processed_at

2) Redis (for high throughput)

key = processed_event:{eventId}

TTL = 24 hours

Example logic:

```
if(eventId exists)
    skip processing
else
    process event
    store eventId
```

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SUMMARY

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Retry → handle temporary failures
Offset → track consumer progress
DLQ → store permanently failed messages
Event ID → uniquely identify event
Duplicate handling → ensure idempotent processing

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KAFKA DLQ (Dead Letter Queue) - SHORT NOTE

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1) WHEN DOES A MESSAGE GO TO DLQ?

A message is sent to DLQ when the consumer fails to process it after retries.

Common reasons:

- Validation failure (invalid payload)
- Deserialization error (JSON parsing issue)
- Business rule failure (missing required fields)
- External dependency failure (DB/API down)
- Retry attempts exhausted

2) HOW DOES IT GO TO DLQ? (SPRING KAFKA)

Spring Kafka uses:

- DefaultErrorHandler
- DeadLetterPublishingRecoverer

Flow:

Consumer → Retry (e.g., 3 times) → Still fails → Sent to DLQ topic

Example config:

@Bean

```
public DefaultErrorHandler errorHandler(KafkaTemplate<String, Object> template) {  
    DeadLetterPublishingRecoverer recoverer =  
        new DeadLetterPublishingRecoverer(template);
```

```
    DefaultErrorHandler handler =  
        new DefaultErrorHandler(recoverer, new FixedBackOff(1000L, 3));
```

```
    return handler;
}
```

3) EXAMPLE SCENARIO

Message:

```
{
  "auditId": null
}
```

Consumer logic:

if (auditId == null) throw Exception

Flow:

main-topic → consumer  → retry → fail → DLQ topic

4) HOW TO FETCH MESSAGE FROM DLQ?

Option 1: Kafka Consumer

```
@KafkaListener(topics = "main-topic.DLT")
public void readDlq(String message) {
    System.out.println("DLQ message: " + message);
}
```

Option 2:

- Kafka UI tools
- CLI consumer

5) HOW TO REPLAY MESSAGE FROM DLQ?

Replay = produce message again to main topic

```
@KafkaListener(topics = "main-topic.DLT")
public void replay(String message,
    @Header(KafkaHeaders.RECEIVED_PARTITION_ID) int partition,
    @Header(KafkaHeaders.RECEIVED_KEY) String key) {

    kafkaTemplate.send("main-topic", key, message);
}
```

}

6) PARTITION HANDLING DURING REPLAY

Case 1: No partition specified

→ Kafka assigns:

- Based on key (hashing)
- Or round-robin

Case 2: Preserve original partition (BEST PRACTICE)

```
kafkaTemplate.send(  
    new ProducerRecord<>("main-topic", partition, key, message)  
);
```

→ Message goes to SAME partition

7) OFFSET HANDLING

- Original offset is NOT reused
- Replay creates NEW message

Example:

Before:

Partition 0 → Offset 10 (failed)

After replay:

Partition 0 → Offset 25 (new message)

8) HOW TO HANDLE FAILED MESSAGE PROPERLY

Best practices:

1. Idempotency

- Use unique eventId
- Avoid duplicate processing

2. Retry limit

- Prevent infinite loops

3. Logging

- Store error details

4. DLQ metadata

- original topic, partition, offset

5. Alerting

- Monitor DLQ size

9) FINAL FLOW SUMMARY

Producer → Main Topic → Consumer

→ (Fail) → Retry → Fail

→ DLQ Topic

→ Ops Fix / Auto Replay

→ Produce Again → Main Topic

→ Consumer (Success)

KEY POINT:

Replay ≠ same message retry

Replay = NEW message with same data
